

THE MOVE

Notice resistance -> name it neutrally -> ask what it carries -> reflect the answer -> adapt or stop. -> Hesitation + neutral label + one diagnostic question + respect for the choice. -> I am hearing some hesitation. What is the main thing that does not ?

START HERE

Notice the resistance, name it neutrally, and ask once what it is telling you before you explain, defend, or persuade.

SAY THIS

Quick openers	"I am hearing some hesitation. What is the main thing that does not work for you?"
Warm / social	"I do not want to push past that. What feels off about it?"
Professional	"I am hearing resistance, which usually means we are missing a constraint. What constraint should we put on the table?"
Digital / text	"I am reading your reply as hesitation rather than a simple no. What is the main blocker?"
Diagnostic asks	"Is this a no, a not-yet, or a yes-if?"
Boundary-safe	"A no is enough; you do not have to justify it. If you want to share the reason, I will listen."

AVOID

- They have given a clear boundary and do not want to explain it
- There is danger, abuse, coercion, or a need for immediate safety action
- You are using the question to keep a negotiation open after a no

REMEMBER

Resistance is often a signpost, not a wall.